

SAVED, FOR NOW: Rafeeqa Bano, who attempted suicide by jumping into Jhelum, being pulled out



EXTREMISM OF ANOTHER KIND

Unending violence, barriers on the freedom of movement and thought are driving the youth of Kashmir towards suicide. The growing numbers point to a total breakdown of mental health.

■ **By Aijaz Hussain in Srinagar**

Abdul Aziz's life in a picturesque south Kashmir village was peaceful till the day his young son killed himself consuming pesticide. His whole family was shattered and so was his social life. The trauma of losing their son increased manifold when fellow villagers raised objections to the family burying their son in the village graveyard. They argued that it was highly condemnable to commit suicide in the Islamic faith and therefore Aziz's son could not be buried in a